

D404

Healthcare Values and Ethics

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A 40-year-old accountant with full decision-making capacity refuses a recommended blood transfusion for religious reasons after hearing the risks. The hospital recently opened a new surgical tower. The team respects her choice. Which principle is most directly honored?

- A. Autonomy
- B. Beneficence
- C. Nonmaleficence
- D. Justice

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A hospital creates a fair, transparent system for deciding who gets scarce ventilators during a surge. Which principle is it applying?

- A. Veracity
- B. Autonomy
- C. Beneficence
- D. Justice

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A patient who speaks limited English signs a surgery consent form after a staff member points to the line and says “sign here.” The patient trusts the hospital because it treated his late father. The surgeon did not explain alternatives. What is the problem?

- A. Consent is valid because he trusts the hospital.
- B. Only an interpreter is missing; the rest is fine.
- C. Consent is not valid: disclosure of alternatives and understanding are missing.
- D. Consent is valid because he signed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A billing clerk at a hospital with 3,000 employees looks up her neighbor's record out of curiosity. The neighbor was admitted last week. The clerk has worked there for 15 years with good reviews. Is this permitted under HIPAA?

- A. Yes, because she has a good record.
- B. No; access without a job-related purpose violates HIPAA.
- C. Yes, since billing is part of payment.
- D. Yes, because she is an employee.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which disclosure requires the patient's written authorization under HIPAA?

- A. Giving the patient's contact list to a drug company for marketing.
- B. Sending a claim to the patient's insurer.
- C. Sending records to a specialist treating the patient.
- D. Internal quality review of care.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A clinic discovers that a stolen, unencrypted laptop held records for 1,200 patients, all living in the same state. The laptop was a two-year-old model. Who must be notified?

- A. No one, since the laptop was stolen, not hacked.
- B. HHS only, in the annual report.
- C. Affected patients, HHS, and prominent media, within 60 days of discovery.
- D. Only the affected patients.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A breach affects 120 patients. When must HHS be notified?

- A. Never; small breaches are exempt.
- B. Within 60 days after the end of the calendar year, in the annual log.
- C. Immediately, along with prominent media.
- D. Only if a patient complains.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A physician who owns 30% of an imaging center refers her Medicare patients there for MRIs. She believes the center has the best machines, and it has a friendly staff. Which law is most directly at issue?

- A. No law, because she believes the machines are best.
- B. The Anti-Kickback Statute only, because it requires intent.
- C. HIPAA
- D. The Stark Law

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A lab pays a physician \$100 for every Medicare patient he sends for testing. Which law does this violate most directly?

- A. EMTALA
- B. The Anti-Kickback Statute
- C. The Stark Law
- D. HIPAA

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A care team disagrees about continuing aggressive treatment for a patient without an advance directive. The senior physician wants to continue; others do not. The hospital recently hired a new CEO. What is the best next step?

- A. Ask the new CEO to decide.
- B. Stop treatment immediately to avoid conflict.
- C. Follow the senior physician because of rank.
- D. Request an ethics committee consultation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A respiratory therapist believes a patient is being kept on a ventilator against the patient's documented wishes. Her manager is new, and the unit is short-staffed. What should she do?

- A.** Raise the concern through the chain of command or an ethics resource.
- B.** Remove the ventilator herself.
- C.** Wait until staffing improves.
- D.** Stay silent to protect team harmony.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

During therapy, a client names a coworker and says he plans to hurt her tomorrow; he has a weapon. The therapist has known him for two years and he has always been polite. What must the therapist do?

- A.** Keep it confidential.
- B.** Ignore it because he has always been polite.
- C.** Take steps to protect the coworker, such as warning her and notifying police, per state law.
- D.** Tell everyone at his workplace.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A 40-year-old accountant with full decision-making capacity refuses a recommended blood transfusion for religious reasons after hearing the risks. ~~The hospital recently opened a new surgical tower.~~ The team respects her choice. Which principle is most directly honored?

Target word: principle in action **Decides:** Capable patient's informed refusal.

A	Correct	Respecting a capable patient's choice.
B	Inverted operation	Beneficence would push toward the transfusion.
C	Confusion set	Avoiding harm is not the reason the team accepts her refusal.
D	Adjacent category	About fair distribution, not individual choice.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A hospital creates a fair, transparent system for deciding who gets scarce ventilators during a surge. Which principle is it applying?

Target word: reverse: from action to principle **Decides:** Fair distribution.

A	Adjacent category	About truth-telling.
B	Confusion set	About individual choice.
C	Adjacent category	About acting for one patient's good.
D	Correct	Fair allocation of scarce resources.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A patient who speaks limited English signs a surgery consent form after a staff member points to the line and says "sign here." ~~The patient trusts the hospital because it treated his late father.~~ The surgeon did not explain alternatives. What is the problem?

Target word: consent validity **Decides:** Missing disclosure and understanding.

A	Camouflage	Trust does not replace disclosure.
B	Dropped element	The surgeon also failed to explain alternatives.
C	Correct	Consent requires more than a signature.
D	Absolute language	A signature alone is not informed consent.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A billing clerk at a hospital ~~with 3,000 employees~~ looks up her neighbor's record out of curiosity. The neighbor was admitted last week. ~~The clerk has worked there for 15 years with good reviews.~~ Is this permitted under HIPAA?

Target word: permitted use? **Decides:** No treatment, payment, or operations purpose.

A	Camouflage	Reviews don't matter.
B	Correct	Minimum necessary and purpose limits apply.
C	Inverted operation	She was not billing this account; curiosity is not payment.
D	Absolute language	Employment does not grant access to any record.

5. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

Which disclosure requires the patient's written authorization under HIPAA?

Target word: reverse: which needs authorization **Decides:** Uses outside treatment, payment, operations.

A	Correct	Marketing requires authorization.
B	Confusion set	Payment — permitted.
C	Confusion set	Treatment — no authorization needed.
D	Adjacent category	Operations — permitted.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A clinic discovers that a stolen, unencrypted laptop held records for 1,200 patients, all living in the same state. ~~The laptop was a two-year-old model.~~ Who must be notified?

Target word: notification scope **Decides:** 500 or more in one state.

A	Camouflage	The method doesn't change the duty.
B	Wrong stem number	The annual log is for breaches under 500.
C	Correct	Large breaches require all three.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out HHS and media for large breaches.

7. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A breach affects 120 patients. When must HHS be notified?

Target word: reverse: small breach timing **Decides:** Under 500 — annual report.

A	Absolute language	All breaches are reported.
B	Correct	Small breaches go to HHS annually; patients still get notice within 60 days.
C	Inverted operation	Media notice is for 500 or more.
D	Adjacent category	Reporting does not depend on complaints.

8. Answer D Concept 5

A physician who owns 30% of an imaging center refers her Medicare patients there for MRIs. She believes the center has the best machines, ~~and it has a friendly staff.~~ Which law is most directly at issue?

Target word: which fraud law **Decides:** Physician self-referral to an entity she owns.

A	Inverted operation	Stark is strict liability; good intentions do not excuse it.
B	Confusion set	The ownership-referral pattern is Stark's core; AKS may also apply but is not most direct.
C	Adjacent category	Privacy law, not referrals.
D	Correct	Physician self-referral for designated services to an owned entity.

9. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A lab pays a physician \$100 for every Medicare patient he sends for testing. Which law does this violate most directly?

Target word: reverse: from conduct to law **Decides:** Payment to induce referrals.

A	Adjacent category	Emergency screening law.
B	Correct	Paying for referrals of federal-program business.
C	Confusion set	Stark covers financial relationships and self-referral; per-referral payments are the textbook kickback.
D	Adjacent category	Privacy law.

10. Answer D Concept 6

A care team disagrees about continuing aggressive treatment for a patient without an advance directive. The senior physician wants to continue; others do not. ~~The hospital recently hired a new CEO.~~ What is the best next step?

Target word: process **Decides:** Unresolved conflict.

A	Camouflage	Irrelevant to the process.
B	Inverted operation	Acts without a structured decision.
C	Adjacent category	Rank does not settle ethics.
D	Correct	Structured, impartial review when conflict persists.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A respiratory therapist believes a patient is being kept on a ventilator against the patient's documented wishes. ~~Her manager is new, and the unit is short-staffed.~~ What should she do?

Target word: responding to moral distress **Decides:** Knows right action, feels blocked.

A	Correct	Speaking up through proper channels.
B	Absolute language	Acting alone bypasses the team and law.
C	Camouflage	Staffing does not change the ethical duty.
D	Inverted operation	Silence prolongs harm and distress.

12. Answer C Concept 8

During therapy, a client names a coworker and says he plans to hurt her tomorrow; he has a weapon. ~~The therapist has known him for two years and he has always been polite.~~ What must the therapist do?

Target word: duty to warn **Decides:** Credible threat against identifiable person.

A	Inverted operation	Confidentiality is not absolute.
B	Camouflage	Past behavior does not cancel a credible threat.
C	Correct	Duty to warn/protect overrides confidentiality.
D	Absolute language	Disclose only what is necessary to protect.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Four principles of bioethics	Autonomy respects self-determination; beneficence means acting for the patient's good; nonmaleficence means avoiding harm; justice means fair distribution of resources and treatment.	Mixing up beneficence (doing good) and nonmaleficence (avoiding harm).	A dilemma where one value clearly drives the choice.
2	Informed consent	Valid consent needs decision-making capacity, disclosure of risks, benefits, and alternatives, understanding, and a voluntary choice free of pressure.	Thinking a signature alone proves informed consent.	A signed form but missing understanding, alternatives, or voluntariness.
3	HIPAA uses and disclosures	Protected health information may be used for treatment, payment, and operations without authorization, limited to the minimum necessary for non-treatment uses; most other uses, such as marketing, require written authorization.	Believing HIPAA bars sharing between treating providers, or that any staff member may view any record.	Who is looking at PHI and for what purpose.
4	HIPAA breach notification	Affected individuals must be told without unreasonable delay and no later than 60 days after discovery; breaches of 500 or more residents of a state also require notice to HHS and prominent media, while smaller breaches are logged and reported to HHS annually.	Thinking small breaches need no notice or that notice waits until the investigation ends.	A breach count and a question about who must be notified.
5	Fraud and abuse laws	The Anti-Kickback Statute bans paying or receiving anything of value to induce federal-program referrals (intent required); the Stark Law bars physician self-referral for designated services to entities they have a financial relationship with (strict liability); the False Claims Act punishes false billing and lets whistleblowers sue.	Mixing up Stark and the Anti-Kickback Statute, or thinking good intentions excuse a Stark violation.	A referral tied to money or ownership, or false claims.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
6	Structured ethical decision-making	Identify the facts and stakeholders, name the conflicting principles, consider options and consequences, choose and justify, and use an ethics committee when conflict cannot be resolved at the bedside.	Deciding on gut feeling, or letting rank alone settle an ethical conflict.	A team deadlocked over an ethical choice.
7	Moral distress and speaking up	Moral distress occurs when you know the right action but feel blocked; the response is to raise concerns through the chain of command or an ethics resource, not stay silent or act alone.	Thinking silence protects team harmony or that you must quietly comply.	A team member uneasy about a decision made above them.
8	Limits of confidentiality	Confidentiality yields when law requires or allows disclosure to prevent serious harm, such as a credible threat against an identifiable person (duty to warn) or mandatory reports of abuse and certain diseases.	Believing confidentiality is absolute, or that any worry justifies disclosure.	A patient's specific threat against a named person.

Course scope (public description): Healthcare Values and Ethics requires students to synthesize an interdisciplinary approach to decision-making as it applies to health and human services. This course explores the contemporary issues facing health professionals, which include ethics, regulations and compliance, and handling protected healthcare information. In this course, learners will develop their ability to make ethical decisions in collaborative care environments and working within a team. There are no prerequisites for this course.